
HOUSE OF NO BRICKS

by **Urban Design Collaborative**



“As the name suggests the project was completely built using materials besides brick. Glass fibre Reinforced Gypsum (GFRG) panels were used to construct both the walls and the roofs of the structure.”

Project Location : Sai Baba Colony, Coimbatore,
Tamil Nadu

Architectural Firm : Urban Design Collaborative

Principal Architect : Nirmal S John Britto

Project Team : Neeraaj S, Ahil M

Plot Area : 3,960 sq ft

Plot Dimensions : 60 X 66 ft

No. of Car Parks : 2

No. of Rooms : 3

Facing : West

Built-up Area : 4,200 sq ft

Timeline : Jan 2019 - Dec 2019

Cost of Project : Rs. 3,000- 4,000 per sq ft



Introduction

In a plot measuring 65 feet x 85 feet on a dead-end road, was the site with an existing 50-year-old house. A new contemporary family home was designed to replace an existing traditional mid-century house. The house was designed to be introverted with the objective to wrap a private green space within

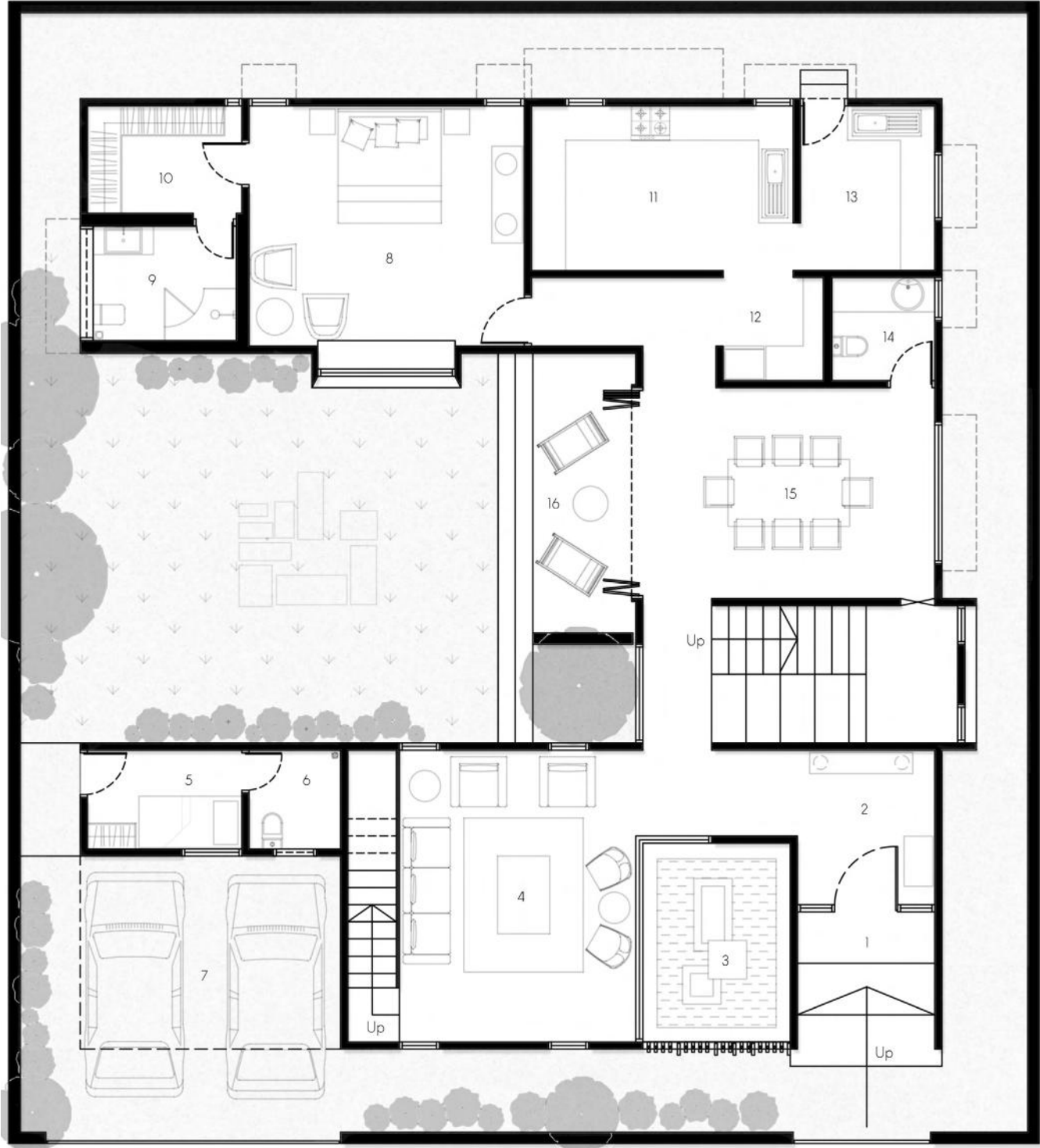
the plot and to organise living spaces around it. Gifted with a reserve park adjacent to the site, the design took the opportunity to use the canopies of the park's large trees as borrowed landscape.



Design Model

The C planned house has its internal garden court designed adjacent to the park site. The nestled landscape allows the clients to use the private garden as a physical extension of the dining space and a visual extension of the bedrooms and living area.

The use of varying internal volumes, water features and landscape greatly help to reduce the internal temperatures.



Ground Floor Plan

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------|
| 1. Vestibule | 9. Master bath |
| 2. Foyer | 10. M. dress |
| 3. Water body | 11. Kitchen |
| 4. Living room | 12. Pantry |
| 5. Servant room | 13. Utility |
| 6. Servant toilet | 14. Powder room |
| 7. Car park | 15. Dining |
| 8. Master bedroom | 16. Outdoor deck |



C- shaped floor plan

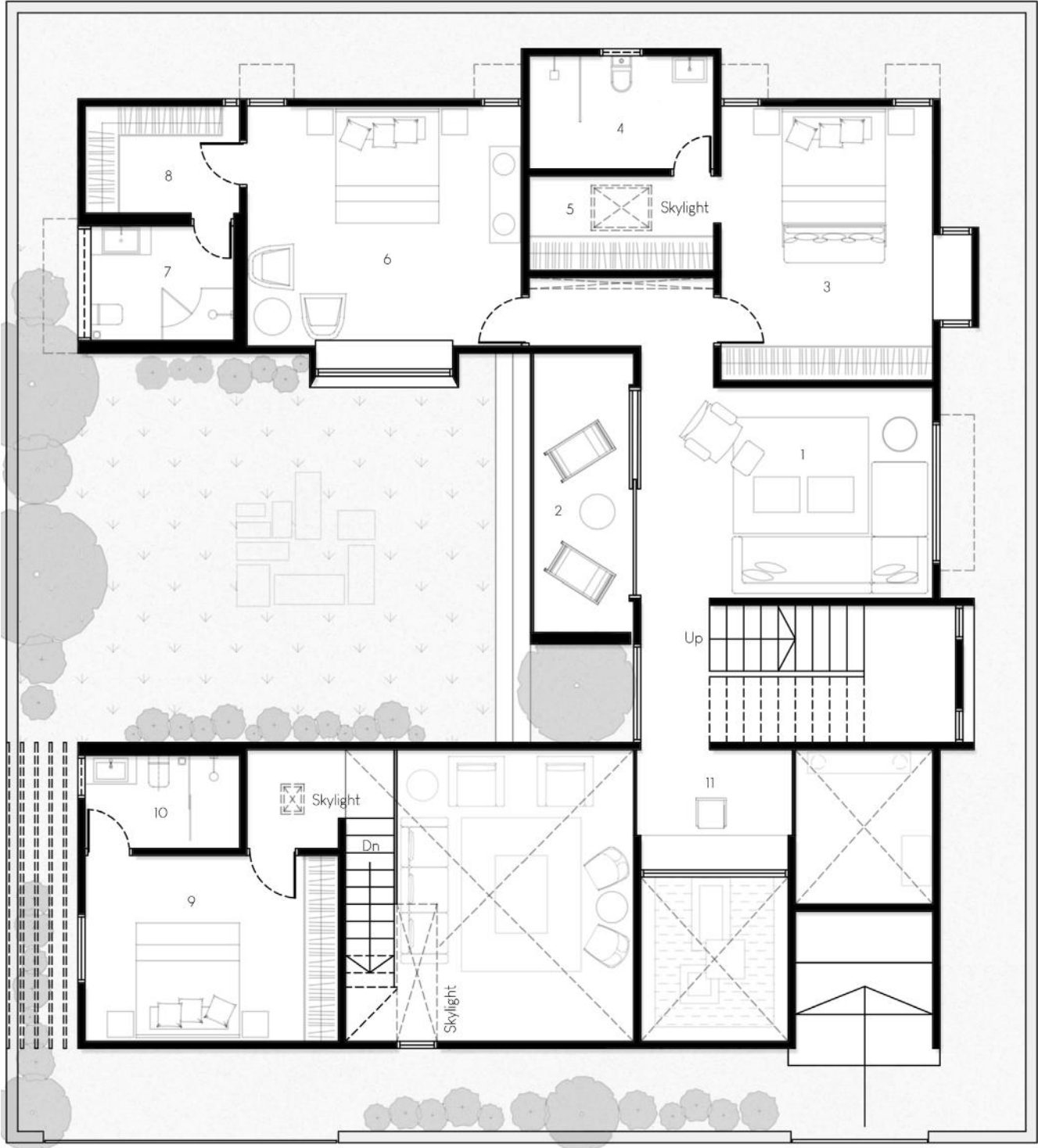
Anyone who enters the building experiences a sense of excitement as they are moving across varying volumetric spatial arrangements. The house is divided into 2 blocks, public and private, separated by a dining area. The bedrooms are provided with a pop-out window that becomes a comfortable nook to over look into the private garden.





Waterbody

Perched within the front block of the house is a black kadappa clad water body with a traditional Kerala stone lamp used as a water spout. The open to sky water body brings in the fresh cool air into the living space. The gurgling sounds of the water body reverberates in the living room.



First Floor Plan

- 1. Family room
- 2. Balcony
- 3. Bedroom_O2
- 4. Bath_O2
- 5. Dress_O2
- 6. Bedroom_O1
- 7. Bath_O1
- 8. Dress_O1
- 9. Guest bedroom
- 10. Guest bath
- 11. Study



Connecting to the Lawn

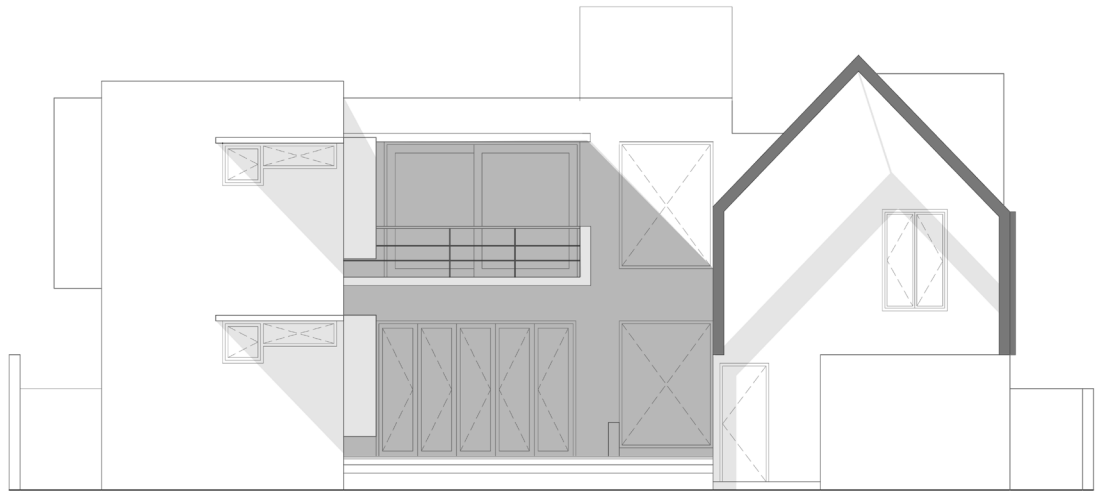
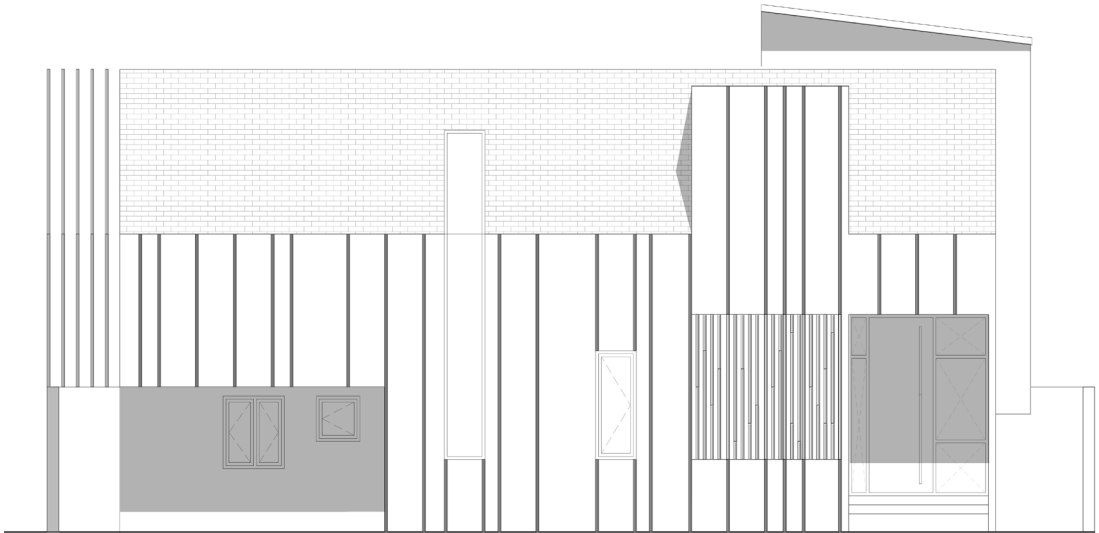
The family lounge on the first floor has ceiling at 8 feet height to make the space feel cosy and comfortable. The low height of the ceiling aided with ceiling high glass openings draws one’s eyes outwards towards the garden and the landscape of the park beyond.





Study Area

The study area on the upper level interacts with the double height volume of the living and foyer area below. It also has a window that overlooks into the water body below as well.



West and North Elevation

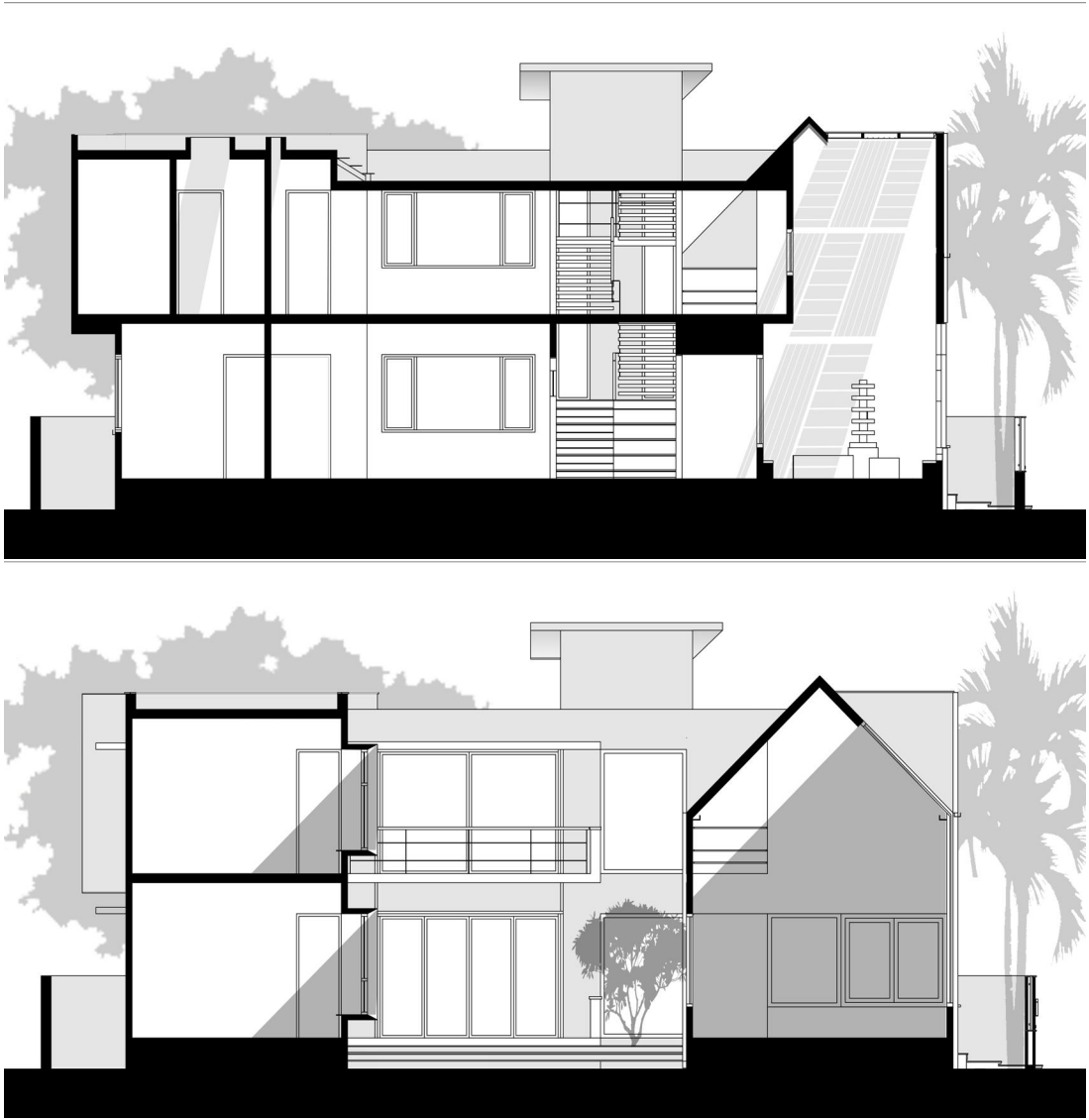
The sloped roof is clad using locally sourced pink slate which changes its hue by the movement of the sun. A gentle splash of rain brings out a shimmering effect on its surface.



East and South Elevation

The windows overlooking the lawn also make the bedrooms feels more spacious.





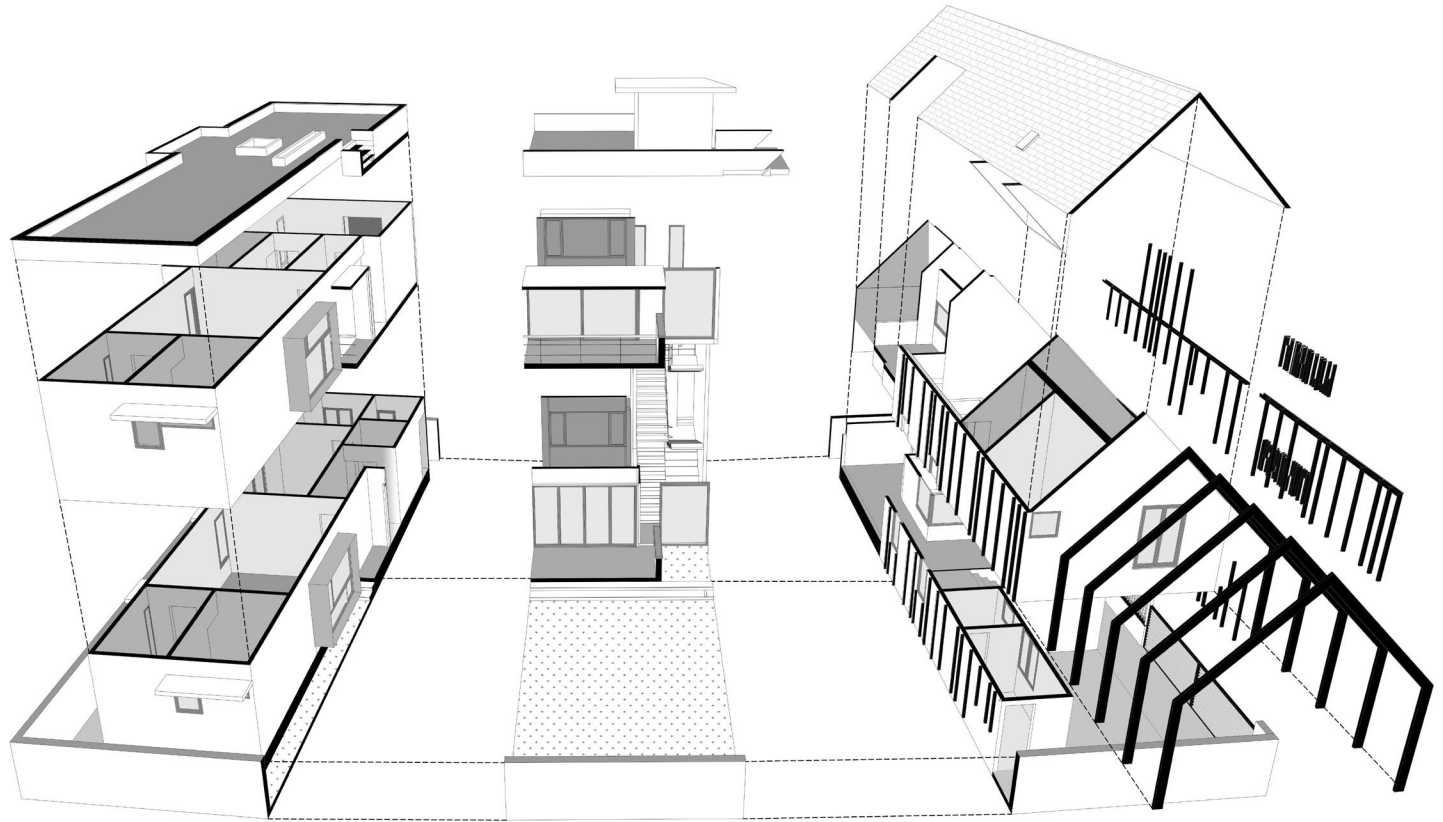
Sections

Sections through (1) Open to sky
waterbody (2) Central Lawn



Staircase

The staircase doubles up as a seating area and a space to display the client’s brassware collection.



Exploded Axonometric

The usage of panel for both the walls and the roof - make it a monolithic structure thereby making it earthquake safe. The use of this technology helped to reduce the internal temperature and has enabled to gain precious carpet area.

This green technology, which manufactures its panels using industrial wastes makes it an environmentally friendly way to build and also has minimum carbon footprint. The use of GFRG panels made it rather easy to erect the 45-degree steep pitched roof that enabled to create dramatic spaces of varying volumes within.

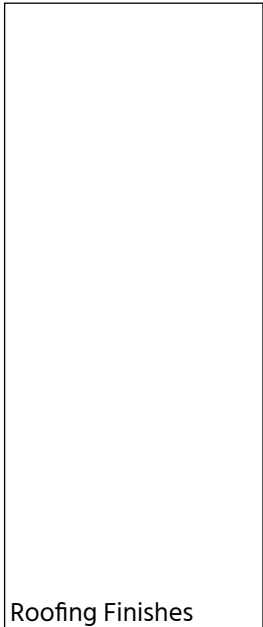


Before and After

The color chosen for the front block of this introverted house is in line with that of the original house.



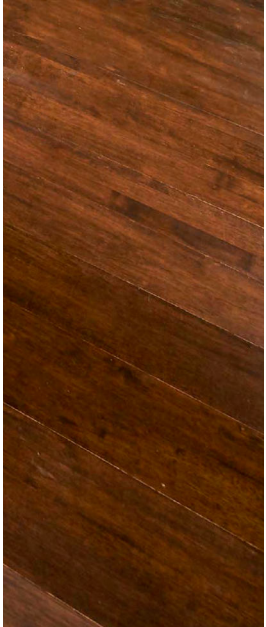
Facade Materials



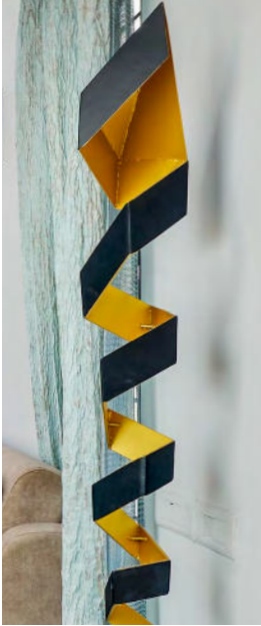
Roofing Finishes



Flooring Materials



Lighting Design



Unique Material Application

Roofing:	Pink Sipri from Maheshwari Marbles
Cladding:	Everest Cladding Board from Hitech Interior
Windows:	AluK from Fencon, Thrissur
Tiles:	RAK, Kajaria, Somany, Pavit from Lakshmi Ceramics
Lighting:	Philips from Prakash Electricals
Color:	Asian Paints from Annamalai Agency
Sanitaryware:	Sternagen, Aquant from SRM Agency
Bath Fittings:	Gessi, Grohe, Vitra from SRM Agency
Furniture:	Maark Trendz
Furnishing:	Pure Fine Fabrics from Symphony Coimbatore
Carpets and Rugs:	Pepperfry
Hardware:	Hettich from South India Hardwares
Modular Kitchen:	Hacker Kitchens from SRM Agency
Kitchen Sink:	Nirali from Bath and Style
Ply:	Century from Swadeshi
Veneer:	Timex from Swadeshi
Laminate:	Greenlam from Swadeshi
Security:	Zicom from INKA Smart Homes
Air Conditioning:	Daikin from Prakash Electricals
Flooring:	Kota and Jaisalmer from Maheshwari Marbles
Construction Material:	GFRG from BACE India

Key Contributors

Structural:	Kaarvens Structural Consultancy
Contractor:	BACE India
Landscape:	Tamara Nursury
Home Automation and Security:	INKA Smart Homes

Photo Credits

Shamanth Patil

